

Volleyball — Official Rules and Scoring Guide

Court Dimensions

A regulation indoor volleyball court measures 18 meters long by 9 meters wide, divided into two 9x9 meter halves by a net. The net height is 2.43 meters for men's competition and 2.24 meters for women's competition. Each side has an attack line 3 meters from the center line, marking the boundary for back-row attacks.

Team Composition

A volleyball team consists of 6 players on court at a time, out of a roster of up to 12-14 players depending on the competition level. Players rotate clockwise one position every time their team wins back the serve, and must serve from the back-right position when it becomes their turn.

Scoring System

Matches are played best-of-5 sets using rally point scoring, where a point is scored on every serve regardless of which team served. The first four sets are played to 25 points, win by 2. If a match reaches a deciding 5th set, it is played to only 15 points, still requiring a 2-point lead to win.

Basic Rules of Play

Each team is allowed a maximum of 3 touches per side before the ball must cross the net, not counting a block touch. A player may not touch the ball twice in succession, except immediately after a block. Players are not allowed to reach over the net to contact the ball, except when blocking an opponent's attack that has already crossed the net plane.

Substitutions and Timeouts

Each team is permitted 6 substitutions per set in most competitive formats, and 2 timeouts of 30 seconds each per set. The Libero, a designated defensive specialist, may enter and exit the game an unlimited number of times but may never serve, block, or attack the ball above net height from the front zone.

Common Faults

A 'four hits' fault occurs when a team touches the ball more than 3 times before returning it. A 'foot fault' occurs when a server steps on or over the end line before contacting the ball. Net faults occur when a player touches the net during play, resulting in an immediate point for the opposing team.